



## EXCERPTS

I was astonished when the priest who was deputed to receive me came and locked me in a tight "welcome embrace". He took me to Lal Bagh and started showing me the many lover couples sitting beneath the trees in intimate postures. He then began to lecture me on the need for physical love... He suddenly embraced me tightly... He squeezed my breasts and asked me to show them... He pushed me down the cot and asked if I had ever seen a man's body and he began to undress himself. After some time he showed me a milk-like liquid and began to enlighten me about how millions of lives throbbed in it.



Gradually I realised that Sister Vimy has turned her attention towards me. She writes pages of love letters to me... As I didn't respond, Sister Vimy turned against me. As I had no other option, considering that she was quite influential, I had to succumb to her sexual advances for a period of time. At night when all were asleep Sister Vimy used to creep into my cot and do indecent things which I could not prevent from happening. She told me she was cautious about having such relationship only with her own sex.

bitterly opposed by the church.

Sister Jesme's book, however, is the most devastating blow to the church. More devastating is the fact that she is a highly educated woman. She has a PhD in English Literature and has authored three books of poems. She had been the principal of the reputed Vimala College in Thrissur, run by the powerful 35 lakh-member Syro-Malabar Church (SMC), the largest Indian Catholic church, before she quit to launch her tell-all autobiography. Neither the

SMC nor the CMC have made any official response to Jesme's revelations. However Fr Paul Thelakat, SMC's official spokesperson, candidly told INDIA TODAY that the issues Jesme raised should not to be ignored and must be addressed by the church and the congregation. "The church and congregation work in a world with all its attendant weaknesses and problems. All the ills of the contemporary world are likely to creep into the church too. Sexual perversions or financial irregularities among the

priests or nuns are not new and there have been isolated incidents." He added that: "Her war is not against God but the disconnect between the ideal and real as she sees it."

The book traces her life from the days when she pursued as a young girl her desire to be a nun to the day she quit the congregation in protest and grief. The narrative is full of instances when she was forced into lesbian relations by senior nuns or sexual liaisons by priests. Jesme said the church never took action against